

# Linear Cryptanalysis

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# Why Study Cryptanalysis?

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

- Cryptographic algorithms are designed to appear random.

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- Cryptographic algorithms are designed to appear random.
- Security depends on the absence of exploitable patterns.
- Cryptanalysis aims to detect and exploit such patterns.

# Why Study Cryptanalysis?

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- Cryptographic algorithms are designed to appear random.
- Security depends on the absence of exploitable patterns.
- Cryptanalysis aims to detect and exploit such patterns.
- Successful attacks help evaluate the strength of a cipher.

## Goal

Find deviations from random behavior that can reveal information about the secret key.

# Linear Cryptanalysis: Basic Idea

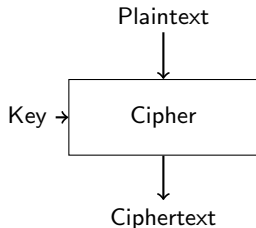
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- Known-plaintext attack.
- Finds approximate linear relations among:
  - Plaintext bits
  - Ciphertext bits
  - Key bits
- Uses statistical bias to distinguish correct key guesses.



$$Pr(L(P, C, K) = 0) = \frac{1}{2} + \epsilon$$

where  $\epsilon$  is called the **bias**.

$$P_1 \oplus P_3 \oplus C_2 \oplus K_5 = 0$$

$$Pr = 0.55$$

(Random expectation: 0.50)

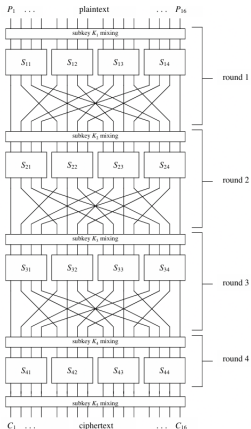
# Substitution Permutation Network

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# Linear Approximation and Bias I

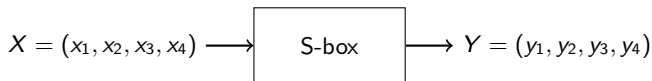
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**Goal:** Find a linear relation between input and output bits of an S-box.



|        |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|--------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| input  | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | A | B | C | D | E | F |
| output | E | 4 | D | 1 | 2 | F | B | 8 | 3 | A | 6 | C | 5 | 9 | 0 | 7 |

**Table 1.** S-box Representation (in hexadecimal)

Example approximation:

$$x_2 \oplus x_3 \oplus y_1 \oplus y_3 \oplus y_4 = 0$$

# Linear Approximation and Bias II

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| $X_1$ | $X_2$ | $X_3$ | $X_4$ | $Y_1$ | $Y_2$ | $Y_3$ | $Y_4$ | $X_2 \oplus X_3 \oplus Y_3$ | $Y_1 \oplus Y_3 \oplus Y_4$ | $X_1 \oplus X_4$ | $Y_2$ | $X_5 \oplus X_4$ | $Y_1 \oplus Y_4$ |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-------|------------------|------------------|
| 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0                           | 0                           | 0                | 1     | 0                | 1                |
| 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0                           | 0                           | 1                | 1     | 1                | 0                |
| 0     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1                           | 0                           | 0                | 1     | 1                | 0                |
| 0     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1                           | 1                           | 1                | 0     | 0                | 1                |
| 0     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 1                           | 1                           | 0                | 0     | 0                | 0                |
| 0     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 1                           | 1                           | 1                | 1     | 1                | 0                |
| 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0                           | 1                           | 0                | 0     | 1                | 0                |
| 0     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0                           | 1                           | 1                | 0     | 0                | 1                |
| 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0                           | 0                           | 1                | 0     | 0                | 1                |
| 1     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 0                           | 0                           | 0                | 0     | 1                | 1                |
| 1     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 1                           | 1                           | 1                | 1     | 1                | 0                |
| 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 1                           | 1                           | 0                | 1     | 0                | 1                |
| 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1                           | 1                           | 1                | 1     | 0                | 1                |
| 1     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 1     | 1                           | 0                           | 0                | 0     | 1                | 0                |
| 1     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0     | 0                           | 0                           | 1                | 0     | 1                | 0                |
| 1     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 0     | 1     | 1     | 1     | 0                           | 0                           | 0                | 1     | 0                | 1                |

Table 3. Sample Linear Approximations of S-box

It holds for 12 out of 16 inputs.

$$Pr = \frac{12}{16} = 0.75$$

Bias:

$$\epsilon = Pr - \frac{1}{2} = 0.75 - 0.50 = 0.25$$



# Linear Approximation and Bias III

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

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## Observation

A non-zero bias indicates a useful linear approximation. Larger  $|\epsilon|$  implies a stronger attack.

## Question:

How can we systematically find strong approximations?

**Answer:** The Linear Approximation Table (LAT).

# Linear Approximation Table (LAT) I

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**Definition:** The LAT records the bias of all possible linear approximations of an S-box.

For input mask  $\alpha$  and output mask  $\beta$ :

$$\alpha \cdot x \oplus \beta \cdot S(x) = 0$$

**Meaning of the masks:**

$$\alpha = (\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3, \alpha_4)$$

selects input bits and

$$\beta = (\beta_1, \beta_2, \beta_3, \beta_4)$$

selects output bits.

For example,

$$\alpha = 0110 \text{ and } \beta = 1011$$

indicates

$$\alpha \cdot x = x_2 \oplus x_3 \text{ and } \beta \cdot S(x) = y_1 \oplus y_3 \oplus y_4.$$

# Linear Approximation Table (LAT) II

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Thus the approximation from the previous slide

$$x_2 \oplus x_3 = y_1 \oplus y_3 \oplus y_4$$

corresponds to the mask pair

$$(\alpha, \beta) = (0110, 1011).$$

The LAT entry is

$$LAT[\alpha, \beta] = \#\{x : \alpha \cdot x = \beta \cdot S(x)\} - \frac{N}{2}$$

where  $N = 2^n$ .

## Interpretation

Large positive or negative values indicate strong linear approximations.

# Linear Approximation Table (LAT) III

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

The LAT contains one entry for every possible mask pair  $(\alpha, \beta)$ . The largest absolute entries correspond to the strongest linear approximations.

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

The LAT for the considered 4-bit S-box is shown below.

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|              |   | Output Sum |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|--------------|---|------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
|              |   | 0          | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | A  | B  | C  | D  | E  | F  |
| Input<br>Sum | 0 | +8         | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  |
|              | 1 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | +6 | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  |
|              | 2 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | -6 | +2 | +2 |
|              | 3 | 0          | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | +2 | -6 | -2 | -2 | +2 | +2 | +2 | -2 | -2 |
|              | 4 | 0          | +2 | 0  | -2 | -2 | -4 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | 0  | +2 | +2 | -4 | +2 | 0  |
|              | 5 | 0          | -2 | -2 | 0  | -2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | -2 | 0  | -4 | +2 | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  |
|              | 6 | 0          | +2 | -2 | +4 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | 0  | -2 | +2 | +4 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 |
|              | 7 | 0          | -2 | 0  | +2 | +2 | -4 | +2 | 0  | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | 0  | +2 |
|              | 8 | 0          | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | -2 | +2 | +2 | -2 | +2 | -2 | -2 | -6 |
|              | 9 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | -2 | -4 | 0  | -2 | +2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | -2 |
|              | A | 0          | +4 | -2 | +2 | -4 | 0  | +2 | -2 | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  |
|              | B | 0          | +4 | 0  | -4 | +4 | 0  | +4 | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  |
|              | C | 0          | -2 | +4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +2 | +4 | 0  | +2 | 0  | -2 |
|              | D | 0          | +2 | +2 | 0  | -2 | +4 | 0  | +2 | -4 | -2 | +2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 |
|              | E | 0          | +2 | +2 | 0  | -2 | -4 | 0  | +2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | -4 | +2 | -2 | 0  |
|              | F | 0          | -2 | -4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | +4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  |

# Properties of the Linear Approximation Table (LAT)

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Let  $S : \mathbb{F}_2^n \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_2^n$  be an  $n$ -bit bijective S-box.

Linear  
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## Important Properties of the LAT

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### 1 Zero-mask entry

$$LAT(0, 0) = 2^{n-1}.$$

### 2 First row and first column

$$LAT(0, \beta) = 0, \quad \forall \beta \neq 0,$$

$$LAT(\alpha, 0) = 0, \quad \forall \alpha \neq 0.$$

### 3 Even-valued entries

$$LAT(\alpha, \beta) \in 2\mathbb{Z}.$$

**Implication:** Large absolute LAT values correspond to strong linear approximations and are desirable for linear cryptanalysis.

# Selecting the Best Linear Approximation

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- Compute the LAT.
- Find entries with the largest absolute values.
- These correspond to the strongest biases.
- Use them to construct multi-round approximations.

$$LAT(0110, 1011) = 4$$

$$\epsilon = \frac{4}{16} = 0.25$$

|       |   | Output Sum |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|-------|---|------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
|       |   | 0          | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | A  | B  | C  | D  | E  | F  |
| Input | 0 | +8         | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  |
|       | 1 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | +6 | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  |
|       | 2 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | -6 | +2 |
|       | 3 | 0          | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | +2 | -6 | -2 | -2 | +2 | +2 | -2 | -2 | -2 |
|       | 4 | 0          | +2 | 0  | -2 | -2 | -4 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | 0  | +2 | +2 | -4 | +2 | 0  |
|       | 5 | 0          | -2 | -2 | 0  | -2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | -2 | 0  | -4 | +2 | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  |
|       | 6 | 0          | +2 | -2 | +4 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | 0  | -2 | +2 | +4 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 |
|       | 7 | 0          | -2 | 0  | +2 | +2 | -4 | +2 | 0  | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | 0  | +2 |
|       | 8 | 0          | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | -2 | +2 | +2 | -2 | +2 | -2 | -2 | -6 | -2 |
|       | 9 | 0          | 0  | -2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | -2 | -4 | 0  | -2 | +2 | 0  | +4 | +2 | -2 |
|       | A | 0          | +4 | -2 | +2 | -4 | 0  | +2 | -2 | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 | +2 | 0  | 0  |
|       | B | 0          | +4 | 0  | -4 | +4 | 0  | +4 | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  | 0  |
|       | C | 0          | -2 | +4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | +2 | +4 | 0  | +2 | 0  | -2 |
|       | D | 0          | +2 | +2 | 0  | -2 | +4 | 0  | +2 | -4 | -2 | +2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | 0  | +2 |
|       | E | 0          | +2 | +2 | 0  | -2 | -4 | 0  | +2 | -2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | -4 | +2 | -2 | 0  |
|       | F | 0          | -2 | -4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  | 0  | -2 | +4 | -2 | -2 | 0  | +2 | 0  |

# Piling-Up Lemma

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Linear  
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Cryptanalysis  
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Suppose  $r$  linear approximations have biases

$$\epsilon_1, \epsilon_2, \dots, \epsilon_r.$$

Then the combined approximation has bias

$$\epsilon = 2^{r-1} \prod_{i=1}^r \epsilon_i.$$

## Observation

Bias decreases rapidly as the number of rounds increases. Therefore, strong single-round approximations are crucial.

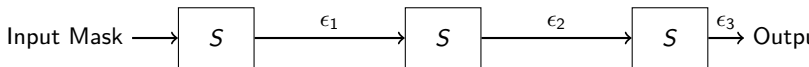
# Example: A 3-Round Linear Characteristic

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Linear  
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Suppose

$$\epsilon_1 = \frac{1}{4}, \quad \epsilon_2 = \frac{1}{8}, \quad \epsilon_3 = \frac{1}{4}.$$

Using the Piling-Up Lemma,

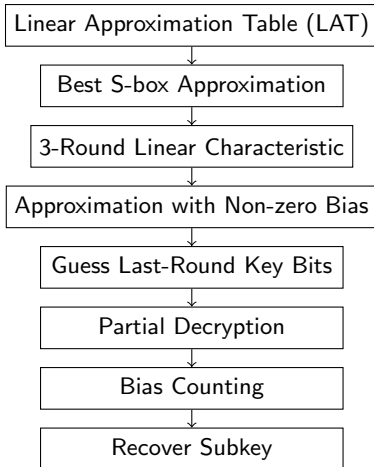
$$\epsilon = 2^2 \left( \frac{1}{4} \right) \left( \frac{1}{8} \right) \left( \frac{1}{4} \right) = \frac{1}{32}.$$

Therefore, the resulting approximation holds with probability

$$Pr = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{32}.$$



# From S-box Bias to Key Recovery



Goal

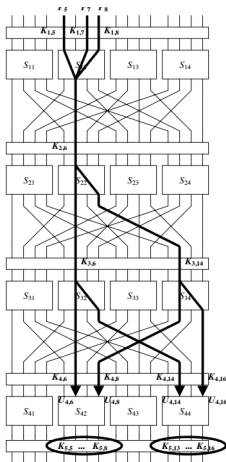
# The 4-Round SPN Cipher I

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Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
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$$S_{12}: X_1 \oplus X_3 \oplus X_4 = Y_2 \quad \text{with probability } 12/16$$

$$S_{22}: X_2 = Y_2 \oplus Y_4 \quad \text{with probability } 4/16$$

$$S_{32}: X_2 = Y_2 \oplus Y_4 \quad \text{with probability } 4/16$$

$$S_{34}: X_2 = Y_2 \oplus Y_4 \quad \text{with probability } 4/16$$

$U_i$ : Input to the round  $i$  s-box and  $V_i$ : output of round  $i$  s-box

# Selecting a Strong S-box Approximation

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From the LAT we choose

$$X_1 \oplus X_3 \oplus X_4 = Y_2$$

Linear  
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It holds for

12 out of 16

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

inputs.

$$Pr = \frac{12}{16} = 0.75$$

Finding Linear  
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Bias:

$$\epsilon = 0.75 - 0.50 = \frac{1}{4}$$

Observation

Large bias implies a useful approximation for cryptanalysis.

We know  $U_1 = P \oplus K_1$  and the linear approximation in the first round is

$$\begin{aligned} V_{1,6} &= U_{1,5} \oplus U_{1,7} \oplus U_{1,8} \\ &= P_5 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus P_7 \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,8} \end{aligned}$$

occurs with probability  $\frac{3}{4}$ .

We know  $U_1 = P \oplus K_1$  and the linear approximation in the first round is

$$\begin{aligned} V_{1,6} &= U_{1,5} \oplus U_{1,7} \oplus U_{1,8} \\ &= P_5 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus P_7 \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,8} \end{aligned}$$

occurs with probability  $\frac{3}{4}$ .

Approximation in the second round

$$\begin{aligned} U_{2,6} &= V_{2,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \\ V_{1,6} \oplus K_{2,6} &= V_{2,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \end{aligned}$$

We know  $U_1 = P \oplus K_1$  and the linear approximation in the first round is

$$\begin{aligned} V_{1,6} &= U_{1,5} \oplus U_{1,7} \oplus U_{1,8} \\ &= P_5 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus P_7 \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,8} \end{aligned}$$

occurs with probability  $\frac{3}{4}$ .

Approximation in the second round

$$\begin{aligned} U_{2,6} &= V_{2,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \\ V_{1,6} \oplus K_{2,6} &= V_{2,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \end{aligned}$$

holds with probability  $\frac{1}{4}$ . Combining both the rounds

$$V_{2,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \oplus P_5 \oplus P_7 \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus K_{1,8} \oplus K_{2,6} = 0 \quad (1)$$

with probability  $\frac{3}{8}$ .

# 3rd round Approximation

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Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
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Approximation of round 3

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} = U_{3,6} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

$$V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} = U_{3,14} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

# 3rd round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
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Approximation of round 3

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} = U_{3,6} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

$$V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} = U_{3,14} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

We know  $U_{3,6} = V_{2,6} \oplus K_{3,6}$  and  $U_{3,14} = V_{2,8} \oplus K_{3,14}$ .



# 3rd round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

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Approximation of round 3

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} = U_{3,6} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

$$V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} = U_{3,14} \text{ holds with probability } \frac{1}{4}$$

We know  $U_{3,6} = V_{2,6} \oplus K_{3,6}$  and  $U_{3,14} = V_{2,8} \oplus K_{3,14}$ . Therefore,

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} \oplus V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} \oplus V_{2,6} \oplus K_{3,6} \oplus V_{2,8} \oplus K_{3,14} = 0 \quad (2)$$

with probability  $\frac{1}{8}$ .

# 3 round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
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Combining the approximation of three rounds

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} \oplus V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} \oplus K_{3,6} \oplus K_{3,14} \oplus P_5 \oplus P_7 \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus K_{1,8} \oplus K_{2,6} = 0$$

# 3 round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
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Combining the approximation of three rounds

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} \oplus V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} \oplus K_{3,6} \oplus K_{3,14} \oplus P_5 \oplus P_7 \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus K_{1,8} \oplus K_{2,6} = 0$$

We know  $U_{4,6} = V_{3,6} \oplus K_{4,6}$ ,  $U_{4,8} = V_{3,14} \oplus K_{4,8}$ ,  $U_{4,14} = V_{3,8} \oplus K_{4,14}$  and  $U_{4,16} = V_{3,16} \oplus K_{4,16}$

# 3 round Approximation

Combining the approximation of three rounds

$$V_{3,6} \oplus V_{3,8} \oplus V_{3,14} \oplus V_{3,16} \oplus K_{3,6} \oplus K_{3,14} \oplus P_5 \oplus P_7 \oplus P_8 \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus K_{1,8} \oplus K_{2,6} = 0$$

We know  $U_{4,6} = V_{3,6} \oplus K_{4,6}$ ,  $U_{4,8} = V_{3,14} \oplus K_{4,8}$ ,  $U_{4,14} = V_{3,8} \oplus K_{4,14}$  and  $U_{4,16} = V_{3,16} \oplus K_{4,16}$  Therefore,

$$U_{4,6} \oplus U_{4,8} \oplus U_{4,14} \oplus U_{4,16} \oplus \Sigma_K = 0$$

where

$$\Sigma_K = K_{4,6} \oplus K_{4,8} \oplus K_{4,14} \oplus K_{4,16} \oplus K_{1,5} \oplus K_{1,7} \oplus K_{1,8} \oplus K_{2,6} \oplus K_{3,6} \oplus K_{3,14}$$

holds with probability  $\frac{15}{32}$ .

# Overall Bias

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

Four active approximations:

$$\epsilon_1 = \frac{1}{4}$$

$$\epsilon_2 = \epsilon_3 = \epsilon_4 = -\frac{1}{4}$$

Using the Piling-Up Lemma,

$$\epsilon = 2^3 \left(\frac{1}{4}\right) \left(-\frac{1}{4}\right)^3 = -\frac{1}{32}.$$

Hence

$$Pr = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{32} = \frac{15}{32}.$$

# Why Partial Decryption?

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Known:

$$(P, C)$$

Unknown:

$$U_{4,6}, U_{4,8}, U_{4,14}, U_{4,16}.$$

These bits occur before the last round.

Idea

Guess a small number of last-round key bits and partially decrypt the ciphertext.

Linear  
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Approximations in  
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# Why Partial Decryption?

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

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Idea

Guess a small number of last-round key bits and partially decrypt the ciphertext.

The approximation involves

$$S_{42} \text{ and } S_{44}.$$

Therefore we guess  $[K_{5,5} \dots K_{5,8}, K_{5,13} \dots K_{5,16}]$

Total key guesses:  $2^8 = 256$ .

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# Key Recovery Algorithm

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

For each key guess:

- 1 Guess 8 key bits.
- 2 Partially decrypt ciphertext.
- 3 Recover

$$U_{4,6}, U_{4,8}, U_{4,14}, U_{4,16}.$$

- 4 Evaluate the linear approximation.
- 5 Update a counter.

Repeat for all plaintext-ciphertext pairs.



# Selecting the Correct Key

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

For a key guess  $k$ ,

$$T_k = \#\{(P, C) : L(P, U_k) = 0\}.$$

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Correct key:

$$T_k \approx N \left( \frac{1}{2} \pm \frac{1}{32} \right).$$

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Wrong key:

$$T_k \approx \frac{N}{2}.$$

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## Decision Rule

Choose the key guess with the largest

$$\left| T_k - \frac{N}{2} \right|.$$

# Example: Key Ranking

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DES

Suppose  $N = 10000$  pairs.

| Key Guess | Count $T$ |
|-----------|-----------|
| 00        | 5010      |
| 01        | 4975      |
| 10        | 5512      |
| 11        | 5031      |

Biases:

$$|5010 - 5000| = 10$$

$$|4975 - 5000| = 25$$

$$|5512 - 5000| = 512$$

$$|5031 - 5000| = 31$$

The key guess 10 is the most likely candidate.

# Key Recovery Principle

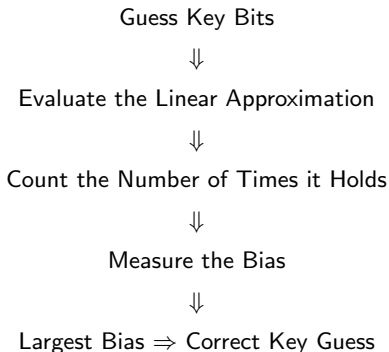
Linear  
Cryptanalysis

**Goal:** Use a linear approximation to identify the correct key bits.

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

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Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

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DES



# Data Complexity

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The number of required plaintext-ciphertext pairs is

$$N \approx \frac{1}{\epsilon^2}.$$

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Cryptanalysis

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of Feistel  
Network

Examples:

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

| Bias $\epsilon$ | Required Data |
|-----------------|---------------|
| 0.1             | 100           |
| 0.01            | $10^4$        |
| 0.001           | $10^6$        |

## Observation

Stronger approximations require fewer data samples.

# Linear Cryptanalysis on Feistel Network

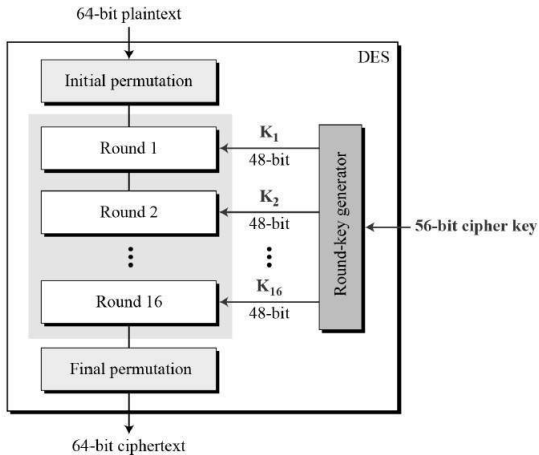
# Data Encryption Standard

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

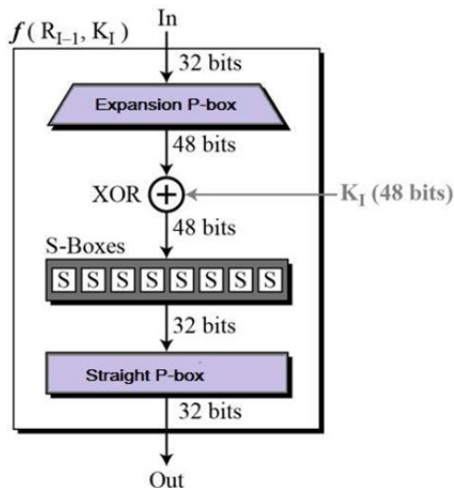
Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES



# Data Encryption Standard-Round Function



# Strategy

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

**How do we find linear approximations in DES?**



# Strategy

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

## How do we find linear approximations in DES?

We study:

- 1 A DES S-box.
- 2 Propagation through the DES  $f$ -function.
- 3 Construction of a 3-round approximation.

# DES S-box $S_5$

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|---|----|----|
| 2  | 12 | 4  | 1  | 7  | 10 | 11 | 6  | 8  | 5  | 3  | 15 | 13 | 0 | 14 | 9  |
| 14 | 11 | 2  | 12 | 4  | 7  | 13 | 1  | 5  | 0  | 15 | 10 | 3  | 9 | 8  | 6  |
| 4  | 2  | 1  | 11 | 10 | 13 | 7  | 8  | 15 | 9  | 12 | 5  | 6  | 3 | 0  | 14 |
| 11 | 8  | 12 | 7  | 1  | 14 | 2  | 13 | 6  | 15 | 0  | 9  | 10 | 4 | 5  | 3  |

Observation from the truth table of  $S_5$ :

$$x_2 = y_1 \oplus y_2 \oplus y_3 \oplus y_4$$

with probability

$$\frac{52}{64} = 0.8125.$$

# DES S-box $S_5$

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|---|----|----|
| 2  | 12 | 4  | 1  | 7  | 10 | 11 | 6  | 8  | 5  | 3  | 15 | 13 | 0 | 14 | 9  |
| 14 | 11 | 2  | 12 | 4  | 7  | 13 | 1  | 5  | 0  | 15 | 10 | 3  | 9 | 8  | 6  |
| 4  | 2  | 1  | 11 | 10 | 13 | 7  | 8  | 15 | 9  | 12 | 5  | 6  | 3 | 0  | 14 |
| 11 | 8  | 12 | 7  | 1  | 14 | 2  | 13 | 6  | 15 | 0  | 9  | 10 | 4 | 5  | 3  |

Observation from the truth table of  $S_5$ :

$$x_2 = y_1 \oplus y_2 \oplus y_3 \oplus y_4$$

with probability

$$\frac{52}{64} = 0.8125.$$

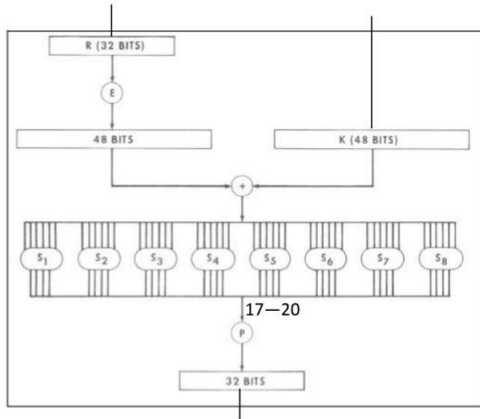
Bias:

$$\varepsilon = \frac{52}{64} - \frac{1}{2} = \frac{20}{64}.$$

## Key Point

The S-box is not perfectly random and exhibits exploitable linear behavior.

# Feistel Function



# Permutation P

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Cryptanalysis

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Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

|    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|
| 16 | 7  | 20 | 21 |
| 29 | 12 | 28 | 17 |
| 1  | 15 | 23 | 26 |
| 5  | 18 | 31 | 10 |
| 2  | 8  | 24 | 14 |
| 32 | 27 | 3  | 9  |
| 19 | 13 | 30 | 6  |
| 22 | 11 | 4  | 25 |

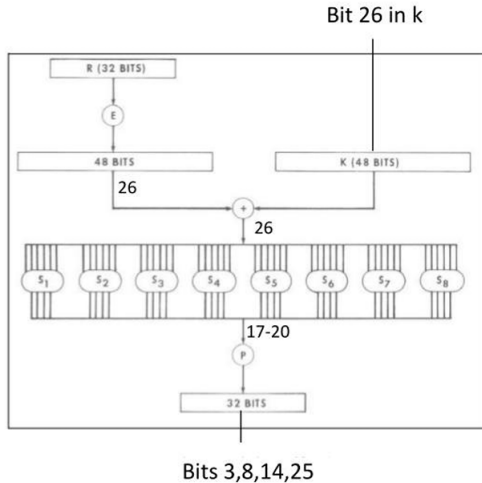
# Feistel Function

Linear  
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Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

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Approximations in  
DES



# Expansion Function

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

E BIT-SELECTION TABLE

|    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| 32 | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  |
| 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  |
| 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 |
| 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 |
| 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 |
| 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 |
| 24 | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 |
| 28 | 29 | 30 | 31 | 32 | 1  |

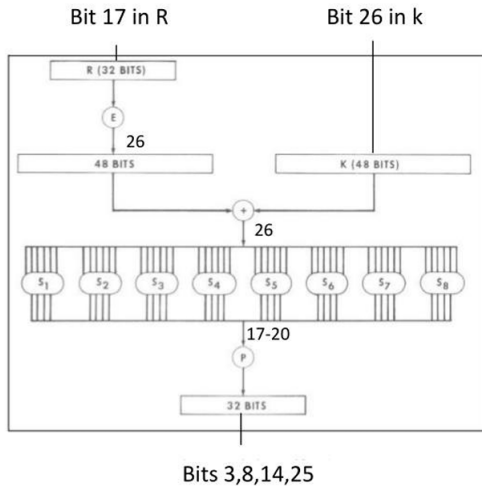
# Feistel Function

Linear  
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Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES





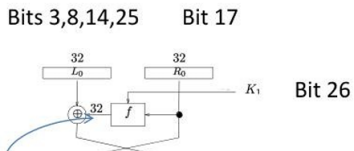
# One Round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES



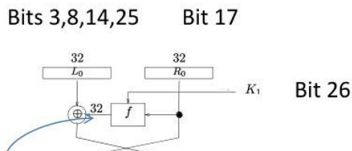
# One Round Approximation

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

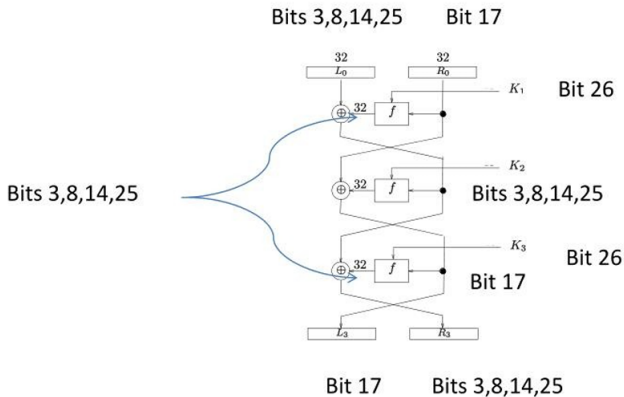


For the first round, the linear approximation is

$$L_0[3] \oplus R_1[3] \oplus L_0[8] \oplus R_1[8] \oplus L_0[14] \oplus R_1[14] \oplus L_0[25] \oplus R_1[25] = K_1[26] \oplus R_0[17]$$

# Extension to 3 rounds

Assume the approximation is extended to three rounds



# 3 round linear approximation

First round linear approximation occurs with probability  $\frac{52}{64}$

$$L_0[3] \oplus R_1[3] \oplus L_0[8] \oplus R_1[8] \oplus L_0[14] \oplus R_1[14] \oplus L_0[25] \oplus R_1[25] = K_1[26] \oplus R_0[17]$$

Third round linear approximation occurs with probability  $\frac{52}{64}$

$$R_3[3] \oplus R_1[3] \oplus R_3[8] \oplus R_1[8] \oplus R_3[14] \oplus R_1[14] \oplus R_3[25] \oplus R_1[25] = K_3[26] \oplus L_3[17]$$

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} L_0[3] \oplus L_0[8] \oplus L_0[14] \oplus L_0[25] \oplus R_3[3] \oplus R_3[8] \oplus R_3[14] \oplus R_3[25] \oplus R_0[17] \\ \oplus L_3[17] = K_1[26] \oplus K_3[26] \end{aligned}$$

holds with probability 0.7 (  $\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2 = \frac{20}{64}$ , bias=0.195)

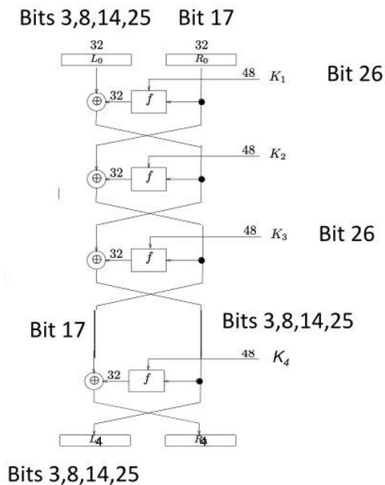
# Attack on 4 round DES

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES



# 4 Round Attack

The approximation is

$$L_0[3] \oplus L_0[8] \oplus L_0[14] \oplus L_0[25] \oplus L_4[3] \oplus L_4[8] \oplus L_4[14] \oplus L_4[25] \oplus R_0[17] \\ \oplus L_3[17] = K_1[26] \oplus K_3[26]$$

We know  $L_3[17] = R_4[17] \oplus F(L_4, K_4)[17]$ .

- Only 6 subkey bits affect the targeted S-box.
- Try all  $2^6$  possibilities.
- The correct guess maximizes the observed bias.

# Conclusion

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

- Linear cryptanalysis is a known-plaintext attack.

# Conclusion

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

- Linear cryptanalysis is a known-plaintext attack.
- The Linear Approximation Table (LAT) helps identify strong linear approximations of S-boxes.



# Conclusion

## Linear Cryptanalysis

### Linear Cryptanalysis

### Linear Cryptanalysis of Feistel Network

### Finding Linear Approximations in DES

- Linear cryptanalysis is a known-plaintext attack.
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- The Piling-Up Lemma allows single-round approximations to be combined into multi-round characteristics.

# Conclusion

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### Linear Cryptanalysis

### Linear Cryptanalysis of Feistel Network

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- Linear cryptanalysis is a known-plaintext attack.
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- The Piling-Up Lemma allows single-round approximations to be combined into multi-round characteristics.
- In SPN ciphers, linear approximations can be used together with partial decryption to recover subkey bits.
- The same principles extend to Feistel ciphers such as DES.

# Conclusion

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

- Linear cryptanalysis is a known-plaintext attack.
- The Linear Approximation Table (LAT) helps identify strong linear approximations of S-boxes.
- The Piling-Up Lemma allows single-round approximations to be combined into multi-round characteristics.
- In SPN ciphers, linear approximations can be used together with partial decryption to recover subkey bits.
- The same principles extend to Feistel ciphers such as DES.
- By guessing a small number of last-round key bits and exploiting the observed bias, key information can be recovered efficiently.

# Future Directions

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis

Linear  
Cryptanalysis  
of Feistel  
Network

Finding Linear  
Approximations in  
DES

The ideas developed in classical linear cryptanalysis have led to several advanced techniques:

- Multiple Linear Cryptanalysis
- Multidimensional Linear Cryptanalysis
- Differential-Linear Cryptanalysis
- Zero-Correlation Linear Cryptanalysis

Thank You